

Sebastian Lewis

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Profile Lead Site Reliability Engineer / Principal Software Engineer with 8+ years' experience building, modernising and operating reliable cloud platforms across financial services, insurance, SaaS and large-scale data environments. Strong background in platform engineering, SRE, DevOps leadership, Kubernetes, Terraform, CI/CD, observability, incident management, disaster recovery, cost optimisation and engineering automation.

Combines hands-on technical depth with platform strategy, technical leadership, mentoring and a track record of delivering measurable improvements in reliability, deployment maturity, cloud cost, disaster recovery and engineering standards. Experienced in helping engineering teams instrument complex systems, turn operational data into reliability metrics, improve incident response, modernise legacy platforms, and partner with engineering, product, and business stakeholders to strengthen operational resilience.

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- Skills**
- **Cloud & Platform:** Azure, AWS, GCP, Kubernetes, AKS, Docker, Istio, Terraform, Helm, ARM, Ansible, Linux, Crossplane
 - **SRE & Reliability:** SLIs/SLOs, error budgets, incident response, postmortems, RCA, disaster recovery, high availability, capacity planning, operational resilience, alerting strategy, toil reduction
 - **Observability & Data:** Grafana, Prometheus, InfluxDB, Coralogix, Sentry, AppInsights, Site24x7, Lightstep, distributed tracing, flamegraphs, Kafka, Redis, log-to-metric pipelines
 - **CI/CD & Automation:** Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, GitHub, Jenkins, Concourse, Airflow, automated testing, dependency management, release automation, CI/CD strategy, AI-assisted engineering, Claude, Copilot, Speckit
 - **Software Engineering:** Python, Node.js, JavaScript, React, Bash, PowerShell, SQL, APIs, networking, secure engineering practices, ETL, Celery/RQ
 - **Leadership & Delivery:** platform strategy, technical leadership, stakeholder management, team leadership, mentoring, standards, platform modernisation, cost optimisation

Work Experience **FactSet - Lead Site Reliability Engineer / Principal Software Engineer, June 2025 - Present**

FactSet is a global financial data and software company providing market data, analytics and enterprise platforms for investment professionals. I work as a Lead SRE / Principal Software Engineer within Platform Infrastructure Engineering, combining reliability engagements with SRE Core ownership of reliability tooling, incident management systems, error budget platforms, observability pipelines and legacy enterprise failover tooling.

- Partner with product and engineering teams to improve operational maturity, helping them instrument complex systems, adopt SLIs/SLOs and error budgets, strengthen postmortems, improve alerting and validate dependencies/changes more effectively.
- Played a key role in a major SRE engagement with a business-critical enterprise trading, execution and order management platform, working with a product group of around 50 people and 5 to 8 key stakeholders to improve reliability practices, incident detection, triage, capacity planning and change validation.
- Created approximately 20 SLIs/SLOs covering end-to-end client experience, supporting clearer reliability measurement, better definition of client-impacting issues and a path toward SLO breach alerting.
- Improved Error Budgets and SLI data-processing tooling covering 1,000+ services, with Python/Kafka/Redis adapter systems processing approximately 10 TB of logs and metrics per day to derive SLIs, transform logs into metrics and support complex reliability use cases such as joining across multiple log lines.
- Improved CI/CD reliability for SRE-owned applications through stronger PR-level validation, representative data testing, clearer dependency-change visibility and dependency automation, reducing failed deployments and manual review effort.
- Modernised Python, Ubuntu and Redis-backed SRE services, including around 10 Python application upgrades, Ubuntu 18/20 to 24+ migrations and Redis 3 to 7 upgrades for critical SLO-breach alerting applications, using cordon-and-drain approaches to avoid downtime.
- Regularly support business-hours and out-of-hours critical incident response, coordinating investigation across systems, networks, data and application teams, and helping teams turn postmortems/RCA into actionable remediation plans that improve resilience and reduce repeat incidents.
- Developed capacity-planning tooling using predictive modelling to forecast usage from internal data sources, integrating predictions with paging/alerting systems and supporting migration of fragmented workloads toward a consolidated Kubernetes/Crossplane platform.

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Work Experience **Insurwave - Lead Platform Engineer, London, July 2023 - June 2025**

Insurwave is a SaaS platform modernising speciality insurance by connecting insurers, brokers and major shipping clients.

- Managed and led a team of 4 platform engineers, reintroducing structure, ceremonies and prioritisation to improve team focus, delivery and platform ownership.
- Defined new Terraform and platform-engineering standards, creating a more secure, observable and reliable framework for infrastructure delivery.
- Standardised deployment of a new AI platform within 6 weeks, reducing infrastructure cost by 70% and reducing new environment deployment time by 90%, from 48 hours to 3 hours.
- Reduced disaster recovery time to under 3 hours and enabled on-the-fly environment creation to support faster client/platform delivery.
- Migrated frontend services from Kubernetes to CDN with zero downtime, improving performance, testability and operational simplicity.

Just Eat Takeaway.com - Senior DevOps Engineer, London, February 2023 - July 2023

Worked within the Data Platforms department, supporting international engineering teams across cloud automation, CI/CD and data-platform tooling.

- Guided international data-platform engineering teams in standardising CI/CD and automation across GCP, Terraform, Airflow and GitHub Actions.
- Created self-service Airflow infrastructure and supported AWS-to-GCP migration work, including Redshift-to-BigQuery data migration patterns.

Insurwave - Platform Engineer, London, February 2021 - January 2023

Platform Engineer for Insurwave's Azure-based speciality-insurance SaaS platform, focused on automation, resilience, observability and secure client delivery.

- Built and maintained core Azure/AKS platform infrastructure using Terraform, Helm and Azure DevOps, including automated provisioning and decommissioning of full environments within minutes.
- Implemented CI/CD, automated quality/security checks and developer self-service workflows to improve delivery speed and platform consistency.
- Built observability, networking and service-mesh capabilities across Grafana, Prometheus, Kiali, AppInsights, Sentry, Istio and VPN-based internal services.
- Delivered disaster recovery, authentication/authorisation, ETL and client-facing platform services, including Azure AD/RBAC, Auth0 and Python-based data workflows.

iPSL – Intelligent Processing Solutions Ltd - DevOps Engineer, Northampton, August 2018 - February 2021

iPSL handled cheque-processing technology for major UK banks including Lloyds, HSBC and Barclays.

- Led Azure DevOps and Git adoption during migration from TFS, becoming the primary SME and training 250+ users.
- Created an automated release strategy that shortened release cycles by 25% and supported a smooth enterprise migration.

Sparta Global – Technical Consultant - DevOps/SDET, May 2018 - July 2020

Technical Consultant specialising in DevOps/SDET practices, supporting client adoption of DevOps tooling and recognised as Sparta Global Employee of the Month.

Education University of Birmingham - BSc Computer Science, 2014-2017

Dissertation - Implementation of hidden functionality within a web page

Key Modules - Software Engineering, Networks, Software System Components, Computer Security, Databases

- Certifications**
- **AZ-900** - Microsoft Azure Fundamentals, September 2020
 - **PSM1** - Professional Scrum Master, February 2020
 - **ISTQB** - Certified Tester Foundation Level, July 2018
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